

County Executive (11)

Office Of The County Exec (11_0100)

COUNTY EXECUTIVE ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

- ✓ In 2024 the Office of the County Executive was responsible for the following achievements:
 - ◆ Continuing to restore fiscal responsibility to the County while increasing the fund balance 22%.
 - ◆ Improved the County's bond rating to AAA with Fitch Ratings, AA+ with S&P Global Ratings and AA1 with Moody's Investors Service.
 - ◆ New York State Comptroller lowered the fiscal stress score for the County to zero. This is the best score a municipality can achieve, indicating outstanding financial stability.
 - ◆ Suspended BeeLine Bus fares for a second summer in a row.
 - ◆ Expanded the Child Care Scholarship Program, broadening eligibility to 500% of the Federal Poverty Level.
 - ◆ Allocated \$1.3 million in funding towards food security to help feed needy families.
 - ◆ Expanded the County's existing textile recycling program by offering curbside collection.
 - ◆ Our Household Recycling Day events attracted 3,500 households, resulting in the collection of over 170,000 pounds of waste.
 - ◆ Honored those lost from COVID-19, our Gold Star mothers, 9/11 illness victims and all veterans who have served this County with dedication.
 - ◆ Worked to cultivate five key sectors for economic development: Life Sciences, Advanced Manufacturing, Clean Energy, Technology and Entrepreneurship.
 - ◆ Hosted job fairs for formerly-incarcerated and justice-impacted individuals and launched our Diverse Abilities initiative which focuses on promoting employment opportunities for those who are disabled in partnership with Westchester County Office for People with Disabilities.
 - ◆ Implemented robust anti-discrimination policies that protect and support all groups within the County.
- ◆ Signed environmental bills that represent the County's commitment to enhancing the quality of life for our community by addressing pressing issues and meeting the evolving needs of our residents. The environmental law package included:
 - The Lead Free Parks Act
 - The Addressing Asthma in Communities of Color Amendment
 - The Renewable Energy Database Act
 - The Equity in Environmental Legislation Act
- ◆ Created the Affordable Housing Investment Flex Fund, a new, affordable housing production tool which was created to help increase the number of units across Westchester.
- ◆ Set aside more than \$1 million for our Black Maternal Child Health Initiative - a three-pronged approach to improve Black maternal and child health outcomes, reduce racial healthcare inequities, and create lasting partnerships with key community groups.

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Objects of Expenditure		Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
Personal Service:							
Annual-Regular:							
	GROUP						
County Executive		1	1	1	1	1	1
Deputy County Executive		1	1	1	1	1	1
Chief Advisor to County Executive		1	1	1	1	1	1
Dir Real Estate		1	1	1	1	1	1
Sr. Asst to County Executive III	XIX	1	1	1	1	1	1
Sr. Asst. to County Executive II	XVIII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Asst. to County Executive IV	XVI	3	3	3	3	3	3
Asst to County Executive III	XV	3	3	3	3	3	3
Asst. to County Executive II	XIII	3	3	3	3	3	3
Asst to County Executive I	XII	2	2	2	2	2	2
Confidential Scheduling Secretary (CE)	XII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Confidential Secretary to CE	XI	1	1	1	1	1	1
Confidential Secretary to DCE	XI	1	1	1	1	1	1
Administrative Aide-County Executive	X	1	1	1	1	1	1
Staff Assistant (ADVOC & COMM)	VIII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Staff Assistant (CE)	VIII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Sr Messenger	IV	1	1	1	1	1	1
		24	24	24	24	24	24
GOVERNMENT RELATIONS							
Sr. Asst. to County Executive II	XVIII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Asst. to County Executive IV	XVI	1	1	1	1	1	1
Confidential Secretary to Chief Advisor	XI	1					
		3	2	2	2	2	2
OFFICE OF COMMUNICATIONS							
Director of Communications	XVIII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Asst to County Executive IV	XVI	1	1	1	1	1	1

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Objects of Expenditure		Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
Admin. Aide - County Executive	X	2	2	2	2	2	2
Sr. Staff Assistant (CE)	IX	1	1	1	1	1	1
Asst. Secretary to County Executive	VI	1	1	1	1	1	1
		6	6	6	6	6	6
Total Positions		33	32	32	32	32	32

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Account Class	Account Rollup Name	Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
100 Annual Regular Salaries	1010 Net-Annual Regular	3,511,499	3,938,897	3,938,897	3,938,897	4,093,724	4,093,724
		3,511,499	3,938,897	3,938,897	3,938,897	4,093,724	4,093,724
101 Other Personal Services	1200 Hourly	89,213	100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000
	1400 Overtime	37,635	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000
		126,848	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000
300 Material & Supplies	3600 Printing & Office Suppl	30,299	32,000	33,402	32,000	32,000	32,000
	3700 Postage Costs	1,492	1,600	1,600	1,600	1,600	1,600
		31,791	33,600	35,002	33,600	33,600	33,600
400 Expenses	4070 Equip Service & Rental	16,333	11,000	11,000	11,000	15,000	15,000
	4110 Travel and Meals	15,842	9,000	9,000	9,000	9,000	9,000
	4140 Communications	7,728	9,000	9,000	9,000	9,000	9,000
	4160 Telephone Expenses	27,818	28,000	28,000	28,000	29,601	29,601
	4380 Contractual Services	100,275	215,000	253,091	215,000	230,000	230,000
		167,996	272,000	310,091	272,000	292,601	292,601
Total Expenditures		3,838,133	4,354,497	4,393,990	4,354,497	4,529,925	4,529,925
99S Inter-Departmental Revenue	9508S Inter Dept Billings	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000
		110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000
Net Expenditures		3,728,133	4,244,497	4,283,990	4,244,497	4,419,925	4,419,925
Net Department Total		3,728,133	4,244,497	4,283,990	4,244,497	4,419,925	4,419,925

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Youth Bureau (11_0400)

Mission Statement

The mission of the Westchester County Youth Bureau is to ensure equity and access to formal and informal services, supports and opportunities for children, youth and families to thrive. The Westchester County Youth Bureau invests the time, talent and financial resources to ensure high quality programming, support and opportunity to Westchester's children, youth and families. Recognizing the extensive diversity and urgency of needs within our community, we are committed to fostering collaboration, integrating youth voice into our work and demonstrating effectiveness within funded programs. By developing comprehensive networks and strategies that integrate prevention, intervention, monitoring and assessments, the Youth Bureau will achieve its goals of preparing children and youth for self-sufficiency and good citizenship, while making formal and informal resources accessible to residents and families.

	2024	2025
POSITIONS		
Operating	8	8
Grants		
	8	8
OPERATING BUDGET EXPENDITURES		
Personal Services	974,095	932,581
Equipment		
Material & Supplies	4,095	4,850
Expenses	3,688,800	3,464,933
Interdepartmental Charges	177,934	205,718
TOTAL EXPENDITURES	4,844,924	4,608,082
OPERATING BUDGET REVENUES		
Interdepartmental	732,798	743,332
Departmental		
State and Federal Aid	116,073	119,433
TOTAL REVENUES	848,871	862,765
DEPARTMENT TAX LEVY	3,996,053	3,745,317
Estimated Share of Miscellaneous Budget Items:		
Retirement Systems	179,226	194,354
Health Insurance and Benefits	282,004	293,064
DEPARTMENT TOTAL	4,457,283	4,232,735

The Appropriated 2024 figures in the supporting detail include all budget amendments through August 31, 2024 and Appropriations Assigned for Purchases on Order ("roll forwards") of \$9,395.

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Youth Bureau (11_0400)

PROGRAM AREA AND SERVICES:

The Youth Bureau deploys financial, technical and relevant resources that promote the social, emotional, physical, psychological and educational well-being of young people throughout Westchester County. Using evidenced based strategies and evaluative tools, the Youth Bureau is responsible for increasing youth access to programs and initiatives that respond to the needs and problems of children and youth from birth to twenty-four and their families. By partnering with local Youth Bureaus, educational institutions, non-profits, units of government, faith based organizations and business, the Youth Bureau ensures that there is a cross-system approach to improving outcomes amongst young people, and in particular, special populations of youth who may be runaway or homeless, LGBTQIA, economically disadvantaged, at risk of placement, or in foster care. In 2024, the Youth Bureau managed 188 programs through 95 agencies and 164 contracts.

Recognizing the extensive diversity and urgency of needs within the entire community, the Youth Bureau is committed to fostering collaboration, integrating youth voice into our work, and demonstrating effectiveness despite complex challenges such as COVID-19, social unrest, and changes in day to day norms. The Bureau has intentionally adopted an equity lens, which is consistent with the County's philosophy and subsequent policy efforts to create justifiable gains across race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, class, and economic backgrounds. By developing comprehensive networks and strategies that integrate assessments, prevention, intervention and monitoring, the Bureau will achieve its goals of preparing children and youth for self-sufficiency and good citizenship, while making formal and informal resources accessible to all residents and families.

The Youth Bureau continuously strives to increase formal and informal resources that lend to children and youths' growth from early childhood

through adolescence to young adulthood. The Bureau is interested in opportunities that lend to the following results:

- Mental health and well-being - Improving outcomes related to youth mental health and social and emotional skills development and connectedness
- Employment - Increasing qualifications and skills, such as collective problem solving, teamwork, and dispute resolution, that help prepare youth for suitable employment
- Educational connection and achievement - More youth attending and completing school with increased attainment, including programs that have collegiate placement success
- Physical health and well-being - Increasing physical activity and positive relationships to one's body and physical activity
- Community cohesion - Breaking down barriers to reduce discrimination, crime, and violence in communities and help young leaders emerge

To ensure that the Youth Bureau's fingers are on the pulse of the community's needs, and innovative, promising practices are integrated into our work, the staff remain active on committees, taskforces, and/or workgroups. Below is a sample of some of the committees that the Executive Director serves on:

- ✓ Westchester County Children's Cabinet
- ✓ Hudson Valley Youth Bureau Association
- ✓ Association of New York State Youth Bureaus
- ✓ Coordinated Children's Services Initiative (CCSI) Committee (Co-chair)
- ✓ New York State Partnership for Youth Justice Team (PYJ)
- ✓ New York State Education Department's Girls of Color Workgroup
- ✓ New York State Youth Justice Institute- Policy Equity Academy
- ✓ Westchester County Reimagine Police Reform Taskforce
- ✓ Westchester County Opioid Taskforce

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- ✓ Gender Responsive Interventions and Partnerships Court of the Ninth Judicial District
- ✓ Westchester District Attorney's Restorative Justice Taskforce
- ✓ Westchester Criminal Justice Advisory Board
- ✓ Westchester-Putnam Workforce Development Board
- ✓ Westchester County Mental Health First Aid Steering Committee
- ✓ Mid-Hudson Regional Youth Juvenile Justice Team (RYJT)
- ✓ Mount Vernon Emerging Adult Justice Community Stakeholder's group
- ✓ Opportunity Youth Part Stakeholder
- ✓ Family First Core Team Meetings
- ✓ Hudson Valley My Brother's Keeper Alliance
- ✓ One Love Foundation Steering Committee to prevent domestic violence
- ✓ WCA Child/Youth Homelessness Workgroup
- ✓ School Reentry Committee and Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Taskforce

FUNDING

The Youth Bureau leverages financial resources to ensure that high-quality offerings are made available to children youth and families throughout the county. Westchester County tax levy dollars have been judiciously used to support Invest in Kids programs along with pilot opportunities for new organizations who are hyper local and have demonstrated effectiveness in serving special populations. The New York State Office of Children and Family Services (NYSOCFS) provides annual resource allocations based on a formula created by New York State and the completion of a comprehensive children and families plan. Below please find a description of the various funding sources:

NEW YORK STATE CHILDREN & FAMILY SERVICES

Youth Development Funding (YD)

Grounded in the Positive Youth Development (PYD), the Youth Bureau administers funding and technical support for the New York State Office of Children and Family Services-Bureau of Youth Development (BYD). The BYD suggests that funded programs be categorized by the following life areas: Economic Security; Physical and Emotional Health; Education; Citizenship and Civic Engagement; Family; and Community. All programs incorporate the eight features of Positive Developmental Settings that the National Research Council has found are essential for quality youth development programs for children and youth. These are:

- ✓ Physical and psychological safety
- ✓ Appropriate structure that provides clear limit setting, rules and expectations
- ✓ Supportive relationships
- ✓ Opportunities to belong
- ✓ Positive social norms
- ✓ Support for efficacy and mattering
- ✓ Opportunities for skill-building
- ✓ Integration of family, school and community efforts

NEW YORK STATE CHILDREN & FAMILY SERVICES

Runaway and Homeless Youth Act Funding (RHY):

RHYA funding supports services to reach, temporarily house and, whenever possible, reintegrate runaway and homeless shelter residents back into their families and communities. A designated Youth Bureau staff serves as the RHY Coordinator. The RHY Coordinator arranges residential and non-residential services and supports in collaboration with the Children's Village Sanctuary Program staff. Services and supports include:

- ✓ An assessment of the need within the County for services to assist runaway and homeless youth and youth in need of crisis intervention or respite services.
- ✓ Ensuring access to public and private resources available to serve runaway and homeless youth using hotlines, street outreach and drop-in centers.

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- ✓ Review/Approve extensions for youth to remain in the shelter.
- ✓ Convening of the RHYA Council
- ✓ Certify new RHY programs

NEW YORK STATE CHILDREN & FAMILY SERVICES

Youth Sports and Education Opportunity Funding (Sports Opportunity Funding):

- ✓ The Sports Opportunity Funding supports programs that provide a variety of sports/physical fitness opportunities for a broad range of youth ages 6-17 in under-resourced communities. Funded programs implement service, opportunities and supports that target specific areas of positive youth development and are guided by the following principles:
- ✓ Sports are effective tools in positive youth development and family engagement, when delivered well by programs and minimum quality measures are met.
- ✓ Sports improve the lives of young people by promoting positive social, emotional, health, and educational outcomes and have important life-long impacts.
- ✓ Sports enable opportunities for young people to succeed economically through leadership roles.
- ✓ Coaching education greatly improves the sports experience and development outcomes of young people.

Team Sports for Youth Funding:

- ✓ NYOCFS has allocated new funding for team sports programs serving youth under 18 years. Funding will be provided starting from October 1, 2024 through September 30, 2025 to local team sports programs in communities where such pro-grams may be scarce or under-resourced. "Team Sports" is defined as an organized physical activity in which groups of two or more individuals are in competition with two or more opposing individuals. Sporting activities where individuals engage in competition on behalf of an organized group (such as singles tennis, team golf, or racing sports such as swimming or skiing) are included in this definition.

NEW YORK STATE CHILDREN & FAMILY SERVICES

Sexual Risk Avoidance Education Program

- ✓ The Sexual Risk Avoidance Education Program (SRAEP), a teen pregnancy prevention and work readiness skills program, was made possible from a state legislative grant received 2023. The program continued to serve the communities of Mt. Vernon, New Rochelle, White Plains, Yonkers, Peekskill, Port Chester and Ossining in an attempt to ensure educate youth on good decision making as it relates to their physical, emotional, and social health.

WESTCHESTER COUNTY TAX LEVY

Invest in Kids Funding

- ✓ The Youth Bureau leverages local tax levy dollars through the Invest in Kids (IIK) Program to achieve its' aims of addressing the physical, economic, social, financial, institutional, and/or other problem(s) impacting Westchester County's youth. Through this competitive funding, local organizations are enlisted to create safety nets that interlock the physical, intellectual, psychological, emotional, and social assets and skills needed for success. The IIK Program legislatively prioritizes "at-risk" youth ages 21 and under in 11 urban communities: Elmsford, Greenburgh, Mount Vernon, New Rochelle, Ossining, Peekskill, Port Chester, Sleepy Hollow, Tarrytown, White Plains, and Yonkers. However, given the recent demographic and socio-economic shifts, along with the salient needs of mental health awareness, physical and socio-emotional health determinants, and the effects of COVID-19 on households throughout Westchester County, service provision to at-risk youth residing outside of the 11 targeted communities has occurred.

Mental Health/ Needs Assessment Funding

- ✓ The Youth Bureau reallocated funding to support the findings of the 2022-2023 Community Youth Needs Assessment. Findings strongly suggested that mental and behavioral health supports were the most salient needs.

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Tobacco and Education Funding

- ✓ The Youth Bureau was allocated funding to support the County Executive's Tobacco and Education Program, made possible, in part by federal funds. The Youth Bureau awarded six organizations funding to plan and implement tobacco specific interventions; community-wide events, and non-political public health campaigns/ reinforcement activities. The Youth Bureau targeted the highest risk populations for tobacco use to include the LGBTQIA youth and young adults, those incarcerated, and those living in the economically distressed neighbors. The Youth Bureau shared its' allocation with the Westchester County Department of Public Safety Stop DWI Program and its' Westchester Coalition for Drug and Alcohol Free Youth.

PRIVATE SECTOR FUNDING

- ✓ The Youth Bureau has been fortunate to develop public-private partnerships with local entities to include financial and in-kind support. An example of these types of partnerships include the New York Presbyterian Hospital, which affords Summer Youth Employment opportunities.

DEPARTMENT ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

NEW

- ✓ The Youth Bureau received funding for the second year in the amount of \$517,896 from the New York State Office for Children and Family Services in the state fiscal year 2024-2025 to provide contract with youth team sports teams for underserved youth. An RFP was developed and released in the fall.
- ✓ The Youth Bureau received \$245,113 in increased funding from the New York State Office for Children and Family Services to provide a variety of sports/physical fitness opportunities for a broad range of youth ages 6-17 in under-resourced communities through programs that target specific areas of positive youth development. An RFP was developed and released in the fall.
- ✓

- ✓ Funding was renewed in the amount of \$260,000 from NEW YORK STATE OFFICE FOR CHILDREN AND FAMILY SERVICES to continue the Sexual Risk Avoidance Education Program (SRAEP), which addresses the need for teen pregnancy prevention utilizing the concept of healthy relationships and future self-development as well as work readiness supports utilizing the READI curriculum.
- ✓ The Youth Bureau secured a fifth year grant from New York Presbyterian Hospitals to support the placement of 60 youth in summer jobs.
- ✓ The Youth Empowerment Council for Change (YECC) continued to work on initiatives and projects throughout the County in keeping with the priorities it highlighted in its 2022 report to the County Executive and Deputy County Executive. Members of the YECC met with NYS legislators, highlighting Westchester as a leader in developing youth advocates.
- ✓ Four pilot programs were funded to support local summer and after-school and mentoring programs.
- ✓ Through the sports and education programming, the Youth Bureau continued to expand services to youth with developmental disabilities to include new partnerships with the Miracle League and others.
- ✓ Through the Youth Team Sports programming, the Youth Bureau supported community based and not-for-profit organizations conducting youth team sports programs in under-resourced communities including teams for youth with disabilities like Able Athletics.
- ✓ The Youth Bureau coordinated meetings with students and New York State elected officials to discuss issues important to them including support for youth programming.
- ✓ The Youth Bureau collaborated with Max Pro to offer direct services to improve physical health and evaluated progress of the participants using fit bits and other technological platforms. Max Pro presented a report on impact of sports on physical and emotional health of youth.

NEW TRAININGS

The Youth Bureau leverages its relationships between community stakeholders and staff to afford training on a wide range of topics including

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best practices concerning emergent youth matters, program evaluation, staff development, grant writing, and positive youth development (PYD). Each year, the Bureau introduces professional development training for executive and line level staff. Highlights in 2024 included:

- ✓ Sanctuary Crisis Shelter Open House
- ✓ Program Design: The Key to Winning Grant Funding Competitions
- ✓ Meeting the Needs of LGBTQ+ Youth in Shelter Settings
- ✓ Meeting the Needs of LGBTQ+ Youth in Positive Youth Development Program Settings
- ✓ Circle of Trauma and Trust-Based Relational Intervention Training
- ✓ WCYB Statistical & Fiscal Reporting Expectations

Additional coaching is provided to non-profit organizations that require capacity building to address the highest risk children and youth. The staff has a mix of expertise, which lends to coaching external staff on best practices when serving at risk populations that include youth who may:

- ✓ Be involved or at risk of becoming involved in the child welfare system (i.e., foster care or aging out of foster care);
- ✓ Be court involved (i.e., Persons in Need of Supervision (PINS), Persons involved with PINS Diversion, Juvenile Delinquents (JDs), Adolescent Offenders (AO) or at risk of coming into contact with the juvenile justice system;
- ✓ Have current or previous adverse childhood experiences;
- ✓ Have perpetuated or have been a victim of gun violence;
- ✓ Be returning to the community from a detention center or incarceration;
- ✓ Be living with a mental health disorder diagnosis and/or are at risk of developing mental, emotional, and/or behavioral disorders (clinical services not allowable);
- ✓ Be at risk of suicide, bullying, unhealthy friendships, and/or domestic violence;
- ✓ Demonstrate poor academic performance and/or at risk of academic failure or school dropout;

- ✓ Be considered runaway and/or homeless;
- ✓ Have alcohol and/or substance abuse issues or demonstrate elevated risk of using alcohol, tobacco, and/or illicit drugs;
- ✓ Have a parent or guardian that is incarcerated;
- ✓ Are a first or second generation child, youth, or family;
- ✓ Identify as LGBTQIA+;
- ✓ Experience gender-specific risk factors;
- ✓ At risk of sexual health compromises to include teen pregnancy, STI/STD infections, and/or other risky behavior; and/or
- ✓ Present barriers to becoming employed due to disability, socio-economic conditions and/or skills deficiencies.

NEW PUBLIC EVENTS

- ✓ The Executive Director will continue working with the Annie E. Casey Foundation's Applied Leadership Network (ALN) team for Westchester County. The Annie E. Casey Foundation's Applied Leadership Network (ALN) aims to develop this potential in leaders and on behalf of youth especially young Black and Latino men who are involved or at risk of being involved with the legal system.
- ✓ The Youth Board hosted the 6th annual virtual "Sheros" Awards Ceremony in March, honoring four key women in the community.
- ✓ The Youth Board hosted the Rosemarie Siragusa Awards Ceremony in May, honoring three dedicated volunteers whose service made an impact on children, youth, and families in the County.

ON-GOING LOCAL AND STATE INITIATIVES

- ✓ 10,100+ youth were reported as served through funded agencies through the Invest in Kids Urban Initiative.
- ✓ 102,900+ children and youth were reported as served through nonprofit and public agencies through the Positive Youth Development and Sports Education Programs.
- ✓ 3,000+ children and youth were reported as served through 19 community based programs.